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W E D N E S D A Y , M A Y 2 7 , 2 0 2 6

A discount for Cup fans — but not here

NYC mayor brokers deal for 1,000 cheaper tickets

By John Hilliard
and Omar Mohammed

GLOBE STAFF

World Cup fever in Boston has perhaps felt more like a stubborn cold rather than the pleasant buzz of anticipation, what with seemingly endless disputes among organizers and host communities, grand promises of parties that now seem out of reach, and ticket prices so high they are turning fans away.

But amid all the messy signals, someone finally scored a win for the average fan: \$50 tickets — with free bus service to and from the games!

... in New York.

There are 11 host cities in the US, including Boston and New York, scheduled to hold World Cup games in just a few weeks. But it is only Boston's most storied rival that secured the dramatic deal for 1,000 tickets for New Yorkers, and only after Mayor Zohran Mamdani reportedly secured a meeting with FIFA's president to help broker the offer.

Now that New York has them, could we see a similar \$50 ticket in Boston, before kickoff at Gillette Stadium, when Scotland faces Haiti on June 13?

Boston Mayor Michelle Wu's office and the Boston 26 host organizing committee did not

WORLD CUP, Page A6

Red flags tell the story when a small college is doomed

By Brooke Hauser

GLOBE STAFF

Every college's story is unique — until it closes.

Then the story becomes all too familiar: In April, Hampshire College and Anna Maria College announced plans to close, joining a wave of schools that have shut down in recent years. The core reasons are largely the same: declining enrollment and revenue.

Despite regulatory interventions that followed in the wake of Mount Ida's abrupt closure in 2018, students and faculty are often caught by surprise when a school shutters.

"A failing institution has no incentive to be candid about its troubles," said Seth Racusen, an associate professor of political science and criminal justice at Anna Maria, "and it has every incentive to cover it up."

Still, higher education watchers say plenty of other warning signs precede a college's decision to close for good, and it behooves students, parents, faculty, staff, and other stakeholders to pay attention to them.

The trend is not encouraging for smaller schools with less-than-robust finances: More

SMALL COLLEGES, Page A10

Loved or hated, DiZoglio is in the game now

Hailed for Legislature fight while accused of playing politics, she's made her own base

By Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — Diana DiZoglio stood in front of a room of seniors at a diner, casually leaning back on a table and cupping a mug of coffee as she explained the idiosyncrasies of her obscure statewide office.

But soon, what was billed as an informational chat with Massachusetts' state auditor turned political. As the men ate their eggs and toast, DiZoglio detailed the pushback she has faced in trying to audit the Legislature. She talked about taking Democratic leadership to court and accused the attorney general of pursuing "stall tactics" to slow her quest.

"Absolute power corrupts,"

DiZoglio said.

"Absolutely!" the room of dozens responded unanimously, quoting the famous English maxim.

Here, in a town represented by Republicans in the House, DiZoglio's strengths were on display: She's good at working a small room, she transcends political party lines, and she can make a winning issue out of railing against the political insiders with whom she



Diana DiZoglio has long bucked the status quo.

shares the Democratic ticket.

She is also perceived as controversial and divisive, and, in some legislative offices, loathed. Her critics view her as driven by ambitions for higher political office or an ulterior motive. And yet, she is all but assured to cruise to reelection, with no Democratic or Republican opponents attempting to challenge an incumbent who, in a paradoxical twist, has no shortage of political enemies.

"The party establishment does not like the fact that what I am doing has drawn support from Republicans, Libertarians, and also fellow

DIZOGLIO, Page A7



DAVID L. RYAN/
GLOBE STAFF

Taking a harder look at the new Copley Square

The redesign was needed, but the ocean of concrete feels empty, particularly when nothing's going on. That will come.

By Murray Whyte

GLOBE STAFF

The new Copley Square, to officially open on Wednesday with a mayoral ribbon-cutting, has its moments. Wandering in from the corner of Boylston and Clarendon Streets is pure delight: A footpath angles away from the urban grid into a leafy glade cast in shadow by

trees and the earthy stone walls of Trinity Church. Tables and chairs cluster along what already feels like an intimate, urbane promenade. It's what public space in a big city should feel like: respite, refuge, but urban all the same.

But, keep walking. Just past the familiar fountain, in place since the square's last do-over in the 1980s, that lovely embrace releases you into the void: a hard expanse of concrete pavers baking one recent morning in the heat of the climbing sun. The contrast is jarring, like an alarm clock going off in the middle of a soothing dream.

Ribbon cutting notwithstanding, the square has been open to the public for weeks now. And

when it first began its slow reveal a year ago, it made a shocking first impression: Gone was the beloved expanse of lawn that stretched from Dartmouth Street to cover two-thirds of the square. In its place, this.

Back then, the Globe published an editorial: "Two years and \$18.9 million for this?" Social media was predictably unkind. "The only thing I want to do in this paved hellscape is attend the guillotine sentencing for the people who thought this change was a good idea," one commentator wrote on Instagram. Ouch.

Much has changed since then: Patches of lawn, dozens of new trees, and an understory of native bushes and shrubs have all been added, greening the fringes of the square; older trees have been freshly buffered from the stresses of the urban environment with root-friendly footings.

But there's literally no way around the big open patch of concrete at its heart, still an aching sore point for many. Like it or not, there are reasons for it. No one knows them better than those most re-

COPLEY SQUARE, Page A10

Markets, beer gardens, and concerts will enliven the space.

'The fact of the matter remains it's still an unsafe environment.'

JEAN CALVERT-MCCLURE, *Department of Mental Health chapter president for the workers union SEIU509*

For Tewksbury State Hospital, a rough balance



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

"It's like a bomb shelter," said Amy Dumont, the hospital's chief executive. "When you're trying to make changes ... going through cinder block is a little bit different."

Attempts to improve security sometimes take toll on treatment

By Jason Laughlin

GLOBE STAFF

Last month, Tewksbury State Hospital, a state-owned facility for people with mental and physical illnesses, made headlines for a series of violent incidents. One patient assaulted another with a sharp object; a patient acting erratically allegedly hit a staff member; a visitor assaulted a pregnant staffer; and a patient hit a worker twice in the face.

Last year, the hospital introduced new safety protocols designed to address violence. The measures appeared to be work-

ing until the state in early April banned security staff from using pepper gel, handcuffs, and batons on patients, in response to a violent incident late last year.

The change prompted an outcry from local police and politicians, led the state to partially reverse its pepper-gel ban, and opened a wide-ranging debate over how to balance treatment and safety at the facility.

On a recent tour of the hospital, state officials acknowledged to the Globe that they could have handled the situation more effectively.

HOSPITAL, Page A7

Now, teens give the orders

When they don't like what's on the table, many send for something else — no matter the cost. **G1.**



Sonny Rollins, widely considered the country's greatest living jazz musician, died at 95. His inventiveness kept him at the creative forefront for six decades. **C9.**

The Celtics' Joe Mazzulla was named NBA Coach of the Year, the first Celtic so honored since 1980. **C1.**

Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton, who was endorsed for the Senate by President Trump, won easily over four-term Senator John Cornyn in a runoff. **A6.**

Let's have a toast

Wednesday: Hot. High 83-88. Low 60-65.

Thursday: Much cooler. High 67-72. Low 53-58.

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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